

ASHOK NARAYANASAMY

QA Practice Leader

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CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- ✓ **QA Leadership & Mentorship:** Manage and mentor diverse QA teams, including internal staff, independent contractors, and vendor resources. Focus on nurturing senior QA leads through tailored coaching, constructive feedback, and skill development initiatives, fostering a culture of excellence and driving professional growth within the team.
- ✓ **Process Improvement Champion:** Proactively partner with chapter leaders to identify inefficiencies and implement strategic corrective measures. Enhance workflows and product delivery processes through data-driven decision-making and fostering cross-team collaboration, resulting in streamlined operations and increased overall efficiency.
- ✓ **Automation & Complex Project Leadership:** Spearhead automation frameworks for complex systems including Microsoft F&O, Salesforce, and Curam. Oversee regression automation projects at CIBC, Telus, and Teck Resources, delivering scalable and high-quality solutions that meet the demanding requirements of multi-layered projects and diverse business environments.
- ✓ **Specialist in Functional & Performance Automation:** Demonstrated expertise in functional automation using tools such as QTP, Ranorex, Tosca, Selenium, and Playwright. Adept in performance testing with JMeter and LoadRunner, ensuring comprehensive validation of functionality and scalability across a wide range of complex project landscapes.
- ✓ **QA Automation Leader:** Drive QA automation initiatives for Tier 1 products, utilizing CI/CD pipelines with Playwright and GitHub to enhance deployment efficiency. Established an Automation Center of Excellence (COE) to promote best practices and address challenges within deployment pipelines, leading to significant improvements in delivery speed and quality.
- ✓ **Performance Testing Leadership:** Lead performance testing initiatives for critical projects, including database upgrades, Windows updates, and the S/4HANA transformation. Manage cross-functional teams to execute performance testing with precision, addressing issues and optimizing performance through detailed analysis and remediation strategies.
- ✓ **Growth-Driven Learner:** Committed to continuous learning and adapting to new challenges, with a strong focus on enhancing QA processes and reporting methodologies. Actively seek out opportunities to stay ahead of industry trends and incorporate innovative approaches, ensuring high-quality outcomes and improved efficiency in all projects.
- ✓ **Clear Communicator in High-Stakes Projects:** Excel in managing high-pressure environments through transparent and effective communication with key stakeholders, including IBM Partners and the Suncor Steering Committee.

Successfully led major initiatives such as the Gensight Implementation and a comprehensive Windows Upgrade program, ensuring seamless execution and addressing operational, technical, and infrastructure challenges with precision.

- ✓ **UAT & Business Collaboration:** Collaborate closely with business directors to accurately identify site-specific requirements and address critical business challenges. Lead User Acceptance Testing (UAT) phases for both internal and external projects, ensuring that deliverables meet business goals and user expectations through meticulous planning and execution.
 - ✓ **Relationship-BUILDER & Risk Mitigator:** Develop and maintain strong collaborative relationships across development, product, agile, and business functions. Employ proactive risk management strategies by regularly communicating with vendor partners and internal teams to identify and mitigate potential resource risks, thereby ensuring that project timelines and objectives are consistently met.
 - ✓ **Recruitment & On-boarding Expert:** Lead the end-to-end recruitment process, from crafting business cases and securing executive approvals to collaborating with procurement on talent acquisition. Ensure effective onboarding processes that enable new hires to quickly become productive and aligned with project goals, contributing to overall team success.
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Teck Resources- Vancouver, Canada
Practice Leader, QA

Oct 2023 – Present

- ✓ As a visionary leader in Digital Analytics, I drive excellence in QA processes and automation, reporting directly to the Director of Digital Analytics IT. I orchestrate seamless project execution by identifying risks early, optimizing resources, and managing vendors with finesse. My strategic acumen ensures that initiatives are executed flawlessly, leveraging cutting-edge automation and CI/CD strategies with tools like Playwright and ADO Pipelines to deliver transformative results.
- ✓ I elevate QA standards through dynamic training and continuous improvement, aligning resources and managing risks to ensure project success. With a commitment to exceptional coaching and personalized feedback, I empower team members to overcome challenges and excel in their careers. My leadership fosters a high-performance culture, celebrating achievements and driving unparalleled excellence across all projects.

DELOITTE- Vancouver, Canada
KalTire | Microsoft Dynamics F&O, Vernon, Canada.
QA Manager (*Responsible for QA activities on KalTire account*)

Oct 2022 – Oct 2023

- ✓ Developed and executed a comprehensive QA strategy covering core application validation, integration, end-to-end, and user acceptance testing. Collaborated with business users, process analysts, and the QA team to ensure thorough coverage and streamlined defect triage using agile-aligned severity levels. Created precise QA estimations and schedules, managed recruitment and onboarding of QA resources, and designed a proof of concept for D365 test automation with Katalon Studio and OpenText UFT. Worked with Deloitte and KalTire directors to refine and approve automation initiatives, and provided biweekly QA reports to stakeholders, showcasing progress and managing risks effectively.

DELOITTE- Vancouver, Canada
CIBC | SFMC Implementation, Toronto, Canada.

Aug 2021 – Dec 2022

QA Manager *(Responsible for QA activities on CIBC Digital account)*

- ✓ Led and managed the QA stream for Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) implementation at CIBC, driving success across three pivotal workstreams: WS1, WS2, and WS3. Orchestrated comprehensive QA activities, including functional, integration, performance, sanity, and production verification testing for SFMC, Sales Cloud Data Platform (CDP), Custom Journey Builder (CJB), and Adobe Journey Builder. Strategically allocated QA resources, providing expert training, mentorship, and oversight to achieve key milestones. Utilized LoadRunner and JMeter for in-depth API performance testing, ensuring exceptional performance and reliability.

TRANSLINK – Vancouver, Canada

Jul 2020 – Aug 2021

Project Manager, QA

- ✓ Spearheaded the development and execution of test strategies for large-scale technology projects, expertly navigating complex business challenges and coordinating with vendors to ensure program success. Crafted a comprehensive program-level test strategy by evaluating functional and technical scopes, schedules, and design artifacts, and collaborated with business analysts, vendors, and technical SMEs to create a robust test data strategy for enterprise systems. Led User Acceptance Testing (UAT), technical, and performance testing phases, aligning vendor activities with project timelines. Developed and maintained a detailed test schedule, managed dependencies, and proactively addressed risks to drive effective resolutions and ensure seamless program execution.

SUNCOR ENERGY CENTER —Calgary, Canada

Jun 2018 – Jun 2020

Program Quality Management Lead

- ✓ Directed QA activities throughout the entire project lifecycle, ensuring seamless daily coordination with testing teams and strict adherence to Suncor QM processes and ADEM Methodology. Oversaw the development and continuous refinement of QM Work Packages, including assessments, test strategies, and summary reports. Accurately estimated test efforts, documented project tasks, and managed day-to-day coordination, escalating critical issues to the Project Team and Suncor QM Lead as needed. Proactively assessed and mitigated testing risks to facilitate smooth production transitions, while fostering effective communication with Suncor business users, IBM QA testers, project delivery teams, and third-party vendors. Collaborated with IBM QA and project teams to implement QM processes, set testing goals, and supervise test planning and execution across multiple projects. Delivered regular test status updates, led Entry and Exit Criteria reviews, coordinated System Integration Testing (SIT) and User Acceptance Testing (UAT), and managed defect resolution and test environment access efficiently.

Readiness & Deployment Lead

- ✓ Championed the global rollout of the Transition Lifecycle model, guaranteeing secure and methodical production transitions for all projects and programs. Led transformative process re-engineering efforts to uphold stringent quality and operational standards, while proactively identifying and mitigating risks throughout the project lifecycle. Served as a pivotal advocate for operational excellence in new service adoption, ensuring strict adherence to procedures and acting as a key liaison among teams. Employed a pragmatic yet structured approach to Service Readiness, protecting EY's operational integrity with top-tier security and quality delivery. Played a crucial role in re-engineering the Service Transition process by collaborating with Operations leads, Transition Deployment Management, and Operational Readiness teams. Cultivated robust relationships with Transition Managers to ensure effective governance and seamless operational transitions

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- TELUS Health, Calgary, Canada. Test Architect. Jun 2016-Feb 2018
- WORKSAFE BC, Vancouver, Canada. Test Lead & Deployment Lead. Mar 2011-Apr 2016
- Fireman's Fund Insurance Corp, Novato, United states, Test Lead. Apr 2008-Mar2011
- Skandia, Southampton, United Kingdom, Senior QA Engineer. Dec 2007 – Apr 2008
- St. George Bank, Australia, Test Engineer, Jun2007 – Dec 2007
- Boeing, Seattle, WA, Software Trainee, Feb2007 – Jul 2007

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Madurai Kamaraj University, India
Bachelor of Engineering in Electronics and Communication

Certifications & Professional Development

Level 1+ Certification from QAI (Quality Assurance International) | Certification of Software Testing (STC)
Six Sigma Green Belt Training

Awards & Recognition

R&R Awards – Livewire, part of FFIC TESTING | R&R Awards – Innovative, part of FFIC TESTING for the production.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

Automation: HP Unified Functional Tester, HP Load Runner, Ranorex, Test Complete, Win runner, JMeter, SOAP UI, Mind Map, Postman, Jenkins, Katalon Studio, playwright, ADO, Jira

ALM &Test Tools: HP Quality Center, Test track pro, JIRA, Clear Quest, Azure DevOps.

Database: DB2, SQL, MS Office, MS SQL Server, Oracle, PL/SQL & IBM DB2

Source Control: VSS, CVS Tortoise, GitHub

Product Enterprises: Microsoft Dynamics, Salesforce Marketing cloud, Salesforce CDP, Salesforce Adobe, Sales cloud, Curam V4.5 Social Enterprise Management Framework, Skandia Client Extranet (Fund Management), SIEBEL 2005, Back-office Processing, K2 Workflows, SharePoint

Technology: SIS, SIMS, OMEGA, Toad, Oracle 11g, Oracle 12c